AI EVERY TIME · CHEAT SHEET

Claude Skills Starter Kit

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from the guide in Guides

1 WHAT A SKILL IS

A folder that teaches Claude one job your way: a `SKILL.md` file with a **name**, a **description** and instructions, plus any templates or scripts.

Claude always sees each skill's name and description; it reads the instructions only when a request needs them, and the extra files only if they're needed.

2 INSTALL IT IN CLAUDE

1. Download the skill's **.zip**. Keep it zipped.
2. **Settings → Capabilities**: turn on **Code execution and file creation** (*Create and edit files* in the newer layout).
3. **Customize → Skills → + → Create skill → Upload a skill**, then choose the zip.
4. Switch the skill on.

Enterprise: an owner turns skills on first, in **Organization settings → Plugins & skills → Policy**.

3 USE IT

- Just ask: Claude picks a skill when your request matches its description.
- To be sure, name it: "Use my quiz-me skill on these notes."
- In Claude Code and the Excel, PowerPoint, Word and Outlook add-ins, type `/` and pick one.
- Not used? Check its switch is on, name it, or sharpen its description.

4 IN CLAUDE CODE

- All projects: unzip into `~/.claude/skills/`
- One project: unzip into `.claude/skills/` and commit it.
- Run one with `/skill-name`; `/skills` lists them.
- Skills switched on in your Claude account sync when you sign in with it.

5 THE TEN SKILLS IN THIS KIT

SKILL	WHAT IT DOES	TRY ASKING
`/learn-anything`	A patient tutor: one idea at a time, with a check after each	*"Teach me how neural networks learn."*
`/quiz-me`	Practice questions from your notes, with every answer explained	*"Quiz me on these notes."*
`/research-brief`	A one-page, sourced brief, each finding with its confidence	*"Give me a brief on..."*
`/news-explainer`	AI and tech news explained plainly, every claim attributed	*"Explain this announcement."*
`/linkedin-post`	LinkedIn posts in your own voice, no invented stories	*"Turn this project into a post."*
`/job-application`	CV and cover letter tailored to a job ad, honestly	*"Tailor my CV to this job ad."*
`/meeting-to-actions`	Decisions, actions with owners and dates, a follow-up email	*"Here's today's call transcript."*
`/presentation-planner`	A talk planned slide by slide, with speaker notes	*"Plan a ten-minute talk."*
`/check-the-numbers`	Data answers proved first; a script profiles each file	*"What drove Q3 revenue?"*
`/skill-maker`	Makes, checks and zips a new skill with you	*"Make my weekly report a skill."*

6 MAKE YOUR OWN

```
weekly-report/
├─ SKILL.md name, description, steps
├─ reference.md detail read when needed
├─ templates/ files to fill in
└─ scripts/ steps that must be exact
```

Test it with three requests that should use it and two that shouldn't. If Claude misses one, improve the description first.

7 THE RULES

- **name**: lowercase letters, numbers, hyphens; 64 characters at most; no "claude" or "anthropic"; same as the folder.
- **description**: what it does **and** when to use it, in the third person; 200 characters at most in the Claude apps.
- **instructions**: under 500 lines; steps, rules, an example, a checklist.
- **zip the folder**, so the zip holds `weekly-report/SKILL.md`.

! BEFORE YOU SWITCH A SKILL ON

Skills can run code. Install them only from sources you trust, and read every file first, especially scripts and anything that downloads software or sends data to a website. Never put passwords, API keys or personal data in a skill.

How skills work: Anthropic's documentation, October 2026